

2112–2095 BCE

GREAT ZIGGURAT BUILT IN UR

After freeing his city from Akkadian and Gutian rule, King Ur-Nammu of Ur founded the neo-Sumerian Third dynasty of Ur. He built a huge ziggurat (step pyramid) in honour of the god Nannar. The monumental structure fell into disrepair after the fall of the Third Dynasty, but was rebuilt in the 6th century BCE by Nabonidus, king of Babylonia.



△ Ziggurat of Ur, restored and rebuilt

c. 2334–2279 BCE **Sargon the Great** conquers Sumer and Mesopotamia and founds the Akkadian Empire

c. 2150 BCE **The kingdom of Nubia** is established in the region to the south of Egypt

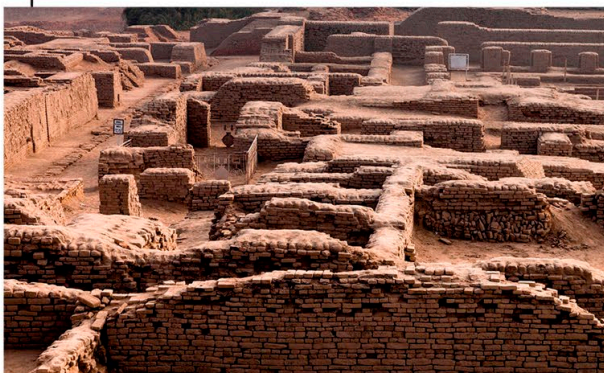
c. 2100–2000 BCE **The Epic of Gilgamesh** is written on tablets in the Sumerian language

2000 BCE

c. 2200 BCE **Iron smelting** is developed in Anatolia by the Hittites; they keep the process a closely guarded secret

c. 2134 BCE **The Egyptian Middle Kingdom** is founded as Mentuhotep II reunifies Egypt

▽ Mohenjo-Daro, city ruins



c. 2500 BCE

CONSTRUCTION OF MOHENJO-DARO

The Harappan civilization of the Indus Valley reached its peak between 2600 and 1900 BCE. It contained several cities, including Harappa and Mohenjo-daro, with populations of about 50,000. Mohenjo-daro in particular was notable for its brick buildings, methodical urban planning, and sophisticated irrigation and sewage systems.

2070–1600 BCE

XIA DYNASTY IN CHINA

According to tradition, Yu the Great founded the Xia Dynasty – the first of the Chinese dynasties – when the Mandate of Heaven was bestowed on him by the last of the mythical Five Sovereigns. Yu became legendary not only for instigating dynastic rule in China, but also for his benevolent and wise leadership. Foremost among his achievements was the work he commissioned to control the persistent floods that threatened his homeland in central China.



△ Yu the Great, legendary founder of the Xia dynasty